participation in terrorist attacks at home and abroad (beyond the provision of training or facilitation of access to al-Qaeda). There are two main drawbacks to such a typology. First, rigid categorization obviously misses the degree to which one form of activity may elide into another. Second, grouping activities by type obscures the chronology of Lashkar's participation in the global jihad in the years immediately after 9/11. However, this is offset by the fact that a thematic representation enables drawing out the extent of the group's various activities during the first half of the decade, which in turn provides a baseline for comparison in terms of their escalation in later years. The examples that follow are intended to illustrate the group's capabilities, reach and motivations, and do not claim to offer an exhaustive account of its activities in 2002–2005. Further, Lashkar's precise connection to various operations and motivation are not always clear. It is sometimes difficult to determine when elements in the group were acting quasi-independently or factions were pursuing their own agendas. Where possible, these distinctions are explicated. Finally, it is notable that in some instances activities associated with Lashkar's participation in the jihad against America and its allies were also used to support operations against India.

Lending a Logistical Hand

There is little indication al-Qaeda believed it would lose its Afghan sanctuary following the 9/11 attacks, but within months its members were fleeing across the border along with other jihadis who also lost their sanctuary when the US invaded. Pashtun tribesman brought the Taliban safely out of Afghanistan into the border regions in Pakistan, and also escorted out between 600–800 Arabs, for which they were well compensated.[119] Most of the major Pakistani outfits also assisted with the exfiltration of al-Qaeda cadres and other Arab jihadis from Afghanistan where possible as well as with facilitating safe haven in Pakistan or safe passage through and out of the country.[120] Of all of these groups, Lashkar had the best network in the country. Its cadres are urbane, able to navigate the cities and ports, and so Lashkar played a major role in moving Arabs, from al-Qaeda and other groups, through the country. It provided safe haven in Pakistan to some. For others, Lashkar facilitated their emigration to the Middle East or other safe destinations despite international watch